

# TANTSА

## Production Decision Companion for Small Food Businesses

**GUESS LESS. MAKE RIGHT. EARN MORE.**

### One-sentence concept

Tantsa helps small prepared-food businesses decide what to prepare, how much to prepare, and when to prepare it using sales history, confirmed orders, available ingredients, batch constraints, and budget - then learns from actual outcomes to improve the next decision.

**The problem** Small food businesses commit ingredients, labor, time, and cash before exact demand is known. Too much becomes leftover value; too little becomes a stockout and missed sale.

### Core question

"Given what I know today, what should I prepare next?"

| Tantsa is                                           | Tantsa is not                                     |
|-----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| A daily production-planning companion               | A generic POS replacement                         |
| A low-data decision layer for small food businesses | A guaranteed AI forecaster                        |
| Merchant-controlled and explainable                 | A food-safety certification                       |
| Able to start with simple records                   | Dependent on enterprise integrations from day one |
| Focused on what, how much, and when to prepare      | A consumer surplus marketplace at launch          |

### Competition fit: Food Security / AI for Food Systems

Measurable claim: reduce avoidable prepared-food loss and improve production decisions - not "solve hunger."

# 1. The Problem

*A repeated operating decision with financial consequences*

- Overproduction - too much food is prepared before demand is known, tying cash up in unsold items.
- Stockouts - too little is prepared, products sell out early, and potential sales are missed.
- Guess-based planning - owners may rely on memory, habit, notebooks, or rough estimates.
- Fragmented information - sales, preorders, leftovers, stockouts, ingredients, batch sizes, and cash limits are rarely combined into one decision.
- Late reaction - slow sell-through may only be noticed near closing, when recovery options are weaker.
- Working-capital pressure - the owner may have a fixed amount of cash available for tomorrow's ingredients.

## Formal problem statement

Small prepared-food businesses make production decisions under uncertain demand and resource constraints. This can lead to avoidable overproduction, stockouts, and inefficient use of working capital. They need an accessible way to turn simple business records into practical, explainable preparation decisions.

## Human story

The owner commits part of tomorrow's livelihood before knowing tomorrow's demand.

## What existing evidence supports

| Evidence                                                                                                                    | What it supports                                        | What it does not prove                     |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| PSA: 37,500 formal accommodation/food-service establishments in 2024; 27,638 restaurant/mobile-food-service businesses [S1] | The sector is economically significant.                 | Not every establishment has Tantsa's pain. |
| Davao Region establishment data previously reviewed [S2]                                                                    | A microbusiness-first local approach is relevant.       | It does not prove willingness to pay.      |
| Philippine food-service research on overproduction/spoilage [S3]                                                            | The pain mechanism is documented.                       | It does not quantify typical Tagum losses. |
| Local bakery operations research on forecasting/scheduling [S4]                                                             | Production planning is an established operational need. | It does not validate Tantsa itself.        |

Evidence boundary: secondary sources are not merchant interviews. Local loss frequency, peso impact, and willingness to pay still require validation.

## 2. Target Market

*Defined by operating behavior, not by one business type*

### Best-fit behavior

Small prepared-food businesses that repeatedly produce before exact demand is known, have a limited selling window, and can measure what they produced, sold, and had left.

| Segment                     | Why it may fit                                                   | Main challenge                                       | Priority |
|-----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Panaderias / small bakeries | Repeat SKUs, batches, clear counts, leftovers and early sellouts | Experienced owners may already have strong routines  | High     |
| Carinderias                 | Daily preparation decisions; strong working-capital sensitivity  | Changing menus, portions, and food-safety complexity | High     |
| Food stalls / kiosks        | Short selling windows; fluctuating place/time demand             | Weather and event volatility                         | High     |
| Small cafes                 | Pastries/sandwiches and time-of-day demand                       | More existing POS competition                        | Medium   |
| Made-to-order sellers       | Costing still useful                                             | Demand is mostly committed; lower leftover pain      | Low      |
| Restaurant chains           | Potential savings at scale                                       | Enterprise integrations and strong incumbents        | Later    |

### Ideal customer profile

- Produces repeatable items several days per week.
- Makes at least part of production before all demand is known.
- Experiences recurring leftovers, late discounting, or stockouts.
- Can record simple daily totals or import them later.
- Owner/operator controls production quantity and pricing.
- Has enough volume that a small monthly fee could be justified by measurable value.

### Go-to-market rule

Interview several segments first. Pilot with the segment where the pain is frequent, expensive, measurable, and practical to record. Do not force bakeries if another segment shows stronger repeat losses.

### 3. How Tantsa Works

*One continuous daily decision loop*

| Stage      | Input                                                       | Output / decision                                     |
|------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. Record  | Recent sales, production, leftovers, stockouts, preorders   | Usable operating history                              |
| 2. Plan    | History + budget + ingredients + batch/capacity constraints | Recommended quantity / range + reasons                |
| 3. Approve | Owner judgment                                              | Accepted or adjusted plan                             |
| 4. Monitor | Midday stock or transaction update                          | Updated sell-through picture                          |
| 5. Act     | Remaining stock + remaining time                            | Next-batch, delay, bundle, markdown, or hold decision |
| 6. Review  | Actual outcome + override reason                            | Next-cycle learning and value review                  |

#### Core product logic

Plan before production. Reassess before waste. Learn after every selling cycle.

#### Illustrative bakery scenario

| Input / event            | Example                                                                     |
|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Normal quantity          | 120 pieces                                                                  |
| Estimated walk-in demand | 72 pieces                                                                   |
| Confirmed preorders      | 12 pieces                                                                   |
| Batch size               | 12 pieces                                                                   |
| Tantsa plan              | 84 pieces total, with staging if practical                                  |
| Initial action           | Prepare 60 pieces; reserve committed orders                                 |
| Checkpoint               | Reassess the remaining 24 after a stock update                              |
| If sales are faster      | Suggest another batch if ingredients and selling time allow                 |
| If sales are slower      | Delay/cancel the next batch; consider an eligible recovery action           |
| Closing                  | Record normal sales, markdown sales, unsold, discarded, and sold-out timing |

All quantities above are illustrative, not pilot results.

## 4. Core Features

*The production recommendation remains the center*

| Feature                     | What it does                                                                           | Business value                               |
|-----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| Quick daily records         | Made, sold, remaining, discarded, sold out                                             | Creates usable history                       |
| Production recommendation   | Suggests quantities within demand, batch, ingredient, capacity, and budget constraints | Balances excess and stockout risk            |
| Confirmed preorder tracking | Separates committed demand from expected walk-ins                                      | Protects commitments without double-counting |
| Kasya sa Puhunan            | Plans quantities within an ingredient-purchasing budget                                | Allocates limited working capital            |
| Batch timing guidance       | Suggests what to prepare first and when to reassess another batch                      | Reduces premature production                 |
| Midday stock update         | Uses current remaining stock or imported transactions                                  | Enables intraday recommendations             |
| Leftover recovery           | Suggests eligible owner-approved bundles, markdowns, donation/disposal                 | Creates a recovery path before closing       |
| Outcome review              | Shows production, sales, waste, stockouts, contribution, overrides                     | Tests whether decisions are improving        |

### Signature feature: Kasya sa Puhunan

"May P1,500 akong pambili bukas. Ano at ilan ang kaya kong ihanda?" Tantsa considers on-hand ingredients, current ingredient costs, menu/recipes, confirmed orders, estimated demand, batch sizes, capacity, and expected contribution, then proposes a feasible production mix.

- If the usual quantity of every product exceeds the budget, Tantsa can preserve confirmed orders while reducing lower-confidence items.
- On-hand inventory reduces tomorrow's cash purchase requirement but still has an economic cost; the app must keep cash requirement and product cost separate.
- For fixed-product bakeries, batch quantity and timing may matter more than budget optimization; the product should adapt to the segment.

## 5. Technology, Low-Data Behavior, and Safety

Use AI only where it adds practical value

| Technology               | Role                                                                           | What must be demonstrated                      |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Multimodal AI            | Turns voice notes or photographed handwritten records into draft entries       | Accurate extraction with owner confirmation    |
| Demand forecasting       | Estimates likely demand and uncertainty                                        | Improves on owner/simple baselines in real use |
| Constrained optimization | Finds feasible quantities under budget, ingredient, batch, and capacity limits | Correct, explainable calculations              |
| Intraday forecasting     | Updates expectations after a stock/sales checkpoint                            | Useful decisions from fresh enough data        |
| Explanation generation   | Explains why the plan changed                                                  | Explanation matches the underlying calculation |

### AI boundary

Costs, quantities, financial results, and safety status must come from structured data, explicit rules, and validated logic. A language model should not invent them.

### Cold-start behavior

| Data available            | Appropriate behavior                                                             |
|---------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| No sales history          | Use owner baseline, confirmed orders, and known constraints. No fake confidence. |
| Limited history           | Use comparable-day averages and clearly show uncertainty.                        |
| More reliable history     | Evaluate forecasting against owner decisions and simple baselines.               |
| Missing/stale midday data | Request an update before giving an intraday recommendation.                      |

- Selling all 80 units does not prove demand was exactly 80; customers may have arrived after stockout. Record sellout time and observed unmet requests where possible.
- Filipino, Cebuano, and mixed-language voice input are promising, but reliable language support should only be claimed after testing.
- Food safety cannot be established by an AI guess or merchant checkbox. If required handling information is missing, do not recommend resale or carryover.

## 6. Differentiation

*Differentiated workflow, not a claim of global uniqueness*

### Positioning

Enterprise-style production planning, simplified for Philippine small food businesses that may have limited data and no integrated POS.

| Product        | Existing strength                                   | Overlap                        | Tantsa difference                                                        |
|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Peddlr         | POS, inventory, expenses, reports, offline          | Records what happened          | Primary job is deciding what to prepare next                             |
| iCost          | Recipe costing, inventory, pricing/analytics        | Food-business economics        | Costing supports the production decision instead of being the core       |
| KwentaPOS      | Bakery POS, recipes, ingredients, offline           | Bakery operations              | Can coexist with POS; focuses on preparation quantity/timing             |
| ClearCOGS      | Restaurant prep forecasting from POS data           | Very close on how much to prep | POS-light, lower-data workflow for smaller Philippine operators          |
| Guac           | Fresh-food demand forecasting / production planning | Very close on forecasting      | Microbusiness-first positioning and simple input path                    |
| Too Good To Go | Surplus/expiry/markdown/marketplace tools           | Leftover recovery              | Recovery is secondary to production prevention; no marketplace at launch |

### What Tantsa combines

- Simple manual, voice, or photo-assisted records.
- Preorders + recent sales + budget/batch/ingredient/capacity constraints in one recommendation.
- Explicit stockout tracking so sold-out days do not teach the model the wrong demand.
- Midday reassessment instead of only next-day forecasting.
- Owner approval and understandable explanations.
- Leftover-risk action before closing, then feedback into the next cycle.

### Do not claim

"First in the world," "competitors cannot do this," or "AI is the moat." The defensible value must come from workflow fit, trusted merchant data, measurable outcomes, retention, distribution, and integrations.

## 7. MVP and Prototype

*Build one complete decision cycle, not a broad platform*

| Module                 | Minimum behavior                                                 | Why it matters                         |
|------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Business/product setup | Products, prices, recipes/yields, batch sizes, optional capacity | Defines economics and constraints      |
| Quick daily log        | Made, sold, leftover/discarded, stockout                         | Creates usable history with low burden |
| Preorders              | Confirmed quantity by date/product                               | Protects committed demand              |
| Planner                | Recommended quantity/range with explanation                      | Core product value                     |
| Budget planner         | Feasible mix under purchasing limit                              | Shows working-capital value            |
| Midday update          | Remaining stock / transaction checkpoint                         | Supports batch timing decisions        |
| Recovery options       | Markdown, bundle, donation/discard where eligible                | Protects value after production        |
| Outcome review         | Actual vs recommended; overrides and trends                      | Shows learning and measurable value    |

### Prototype screens

- 1. Onboarding / products / recipe or cost / batch size.
- 2. Quick record: made, sold, leftover, discarded, sold out.
- 3. Tomorrow's plan: preorders, budget, ingredients, and proposed quantities.
- 4. Owner approval: adjust quantity and record reason.
- 5. Midday update: remaining stock and conditional next-batch suggestion.
- 6. Outcome review: what happened, leftover/stockout trend, and financial interpretation.

### Optional polish

If time permits, add one voice-input demonstration that converts a natural-language record into draft structured fields and requires owner confirmation.

### Do not build yet

Full POS, payment custody, consumer marketplace, tax invoicing, automatic food-safety decisions, complex multi-branch integrations, or advanced AI claims.

## 8. Business Model and Investor Logic

*Commercial story: money protected, not AI*

| Stage                        | Offer                                                            | Purpose                                         |
|------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| Pilot                        | Assisted setup, daily records, planning                          | Prove value and data feasibility                |
| Single-business subscription | Recommendations, budget planning, alerts, outcome review         | Test paid retention                             |
| Team / branch plan           | Roles, shared products, branch planning, consolidated purchasing | Expand revenue within growing customers         |
| Integrations later           | POS and order-system connections                                 | Reduce input effort and support larger accounts |

### Test price

P299/month may be used as an experiment because local business tools already use similar price points. It is not validated for Tantsa.

### Value metrics

| Metric                               | What it tells us                                     |
|--------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Unsold quantity / production         | Whether overproduction is changing                   |
| Discarded quantity                   | Whether actual waste is changing                     |
| Stockout frequency and timing        | Whether lower production is causing shortages        |
| Revenue minus defined variable costs | Whether operating contribution is improving          |
| Daily recording time                 | Whether the workflow is practical                    |
| Recommendation use / overrides       | Whether owners find the decision useful              |
| Paid conversion / renewal            | Whether value is strong enough to support a business |

### Investor questions Tantsa must eventually answer

- How much does a qualified merchant actually lose from production mistakes?
- Does Tantsa reduce unsold output without materially increasing stockouts?
- How many minutes per day does data entry take?
- Do merchants keep using recommendations after novelty wears off?
- How many pay and renew after the trial?
- Can customer acquisition and support costs be recovered from subscription margin?
- What prevents a POS provider from copying the feature?

## 9. Go-to-Market and Validation

*Use real merchant behavior as the filter*

### Marketing message

#### Primary hook

"Not sure how much to prepare tomorrow?" Tantsa learns from what you made, sold, had left, and sold out - then helps you plan the next batch.

| Channel / tactic           | How to use it                                                                          |
|----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Direct merchant visits     | Ask about yesterday's leftovers and stockouts; demonstrate with their own numbers.     |
| Free trial                 | Let merchants record 1-2 weeks, then show patterns before asking them to pay.          |
| Facebook / TikTok          | Short peso-based examples: made vs sold vs remaining, then the next-day decision.      |
| Local food-business groups | Reach bakeries, carinderias, stalls, cafes, and MSME communities.                      |
| Referral                   | Merchant invites another business; use trial extension only if economics support it.   |
| Partners later             | Negosyo Centers, coops, food associations, culinary schools, suppliers, POS providers. |
| Success stories            | Use measured outcomes as the strongest advertisement.                                  |

### Validation plan

- Week 1: 15-20 discovery interviews across relevant segments. Collect recent leftovers, sellouts, decision method, budget constraints, and current records.
- Week 2: onboard up to 10 pilot merchants; measure setup time and data quality.
- Weeks 3-4: observe baseline production, leftovers, stockouts, and recording burden without recommendations.
- Weeks 5-6: turn recommendations on; track adoption, overrides, unsold ratio, stockouts, and contribution.
- After trial: offer a real paid subscription; measure conversion, renewal, and cancellation reasons.

#### Decision rule

If merchants do not lose enough from production mistakes to care about "what should I prepare next?", do not rescue the idea by adding more dashboards, AI, or marketplace features. Pivot.

## 10. INNOVATHON Fit and 4-Minute Pitch

*Keep the story focused on one merchant decision*

| Judging criterion         | Weight | What Tantsa should show                                                                          |
|---------------------------|--------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Problem understanding     | 25%    | Specific merchant pain supported by interviews/observation or clearly labeled secondary evidence |
| Feasibility & scalability | 25%    | Focused prototype, low-data behavior, realistic staged integrations                              |
| Projected impact          | 25%    | Waste, stockout, working-capital, and financial measures                                         |
| Implementation plan       | 15%    | Pilot design, data needs, validation gates, next steps                                           |
| Presentation              | 10%    | One clear customer story and understandable demonstration                                        |

### Suggested 4-minute flow

| Time      | Pitch content                                                                                                                           |
|-----------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 0:00-0:35 | Small food sellers commit cash before knowing demand. Too much becomes leftover value; too little becomes a stockout.                   |
| 0:35-1:05 | Define the best-fit behavior: repeat production, uncertain demand, limited selling window, measurable outcomes.                         |
| 1:05-2:15 | Demo one scenario: history + preorders + budget/constraints -> plan -> owner approval -> midday update -> next-batch/recovery decision. |
| 2:15-2:50 | Differentiate honestly: POS/costing and forecasting tools exist; Tantsa simplifies the workflow for small Philippine operators.         |
| 2:50-3:25 | Show measurable value: unsold quantity, stockouts, recording time, working capital, contribution, and paid conversion.                  |
| 3:25-4:00 | Scalability: start with the highest-pain segment, then expand to adjacent food businesses and integrations.                             |

### Opening line

"Every food business has a tantsa - how much to cook, bake, or prepare. The problem is that this tantsa often depends on memory and instinct. Tantsa turns that judgment into a practical, data-supported daily decision."

# 11. Hard Judge Questions

*Short, defensible answers*

| Question                                | Defensible answer                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|-----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Is it new?                              | Not as a technology category. The innovation is the simplified low-data workflow that combines production planning, budget/batch constraints, intraday reassessment, recovery, and next-cycle learning for small Philippine operators. |
| Why not Peddlr / iCost / KwentaPOS?     | Those tools solve valuable POS, costing, and inventory needs. Tantsa's primary job is deciding what, how much, and when to prepare.                                                                                                    |
| ClearCOGS / Guac already forecast prep. | Yes. That validates the category. Tantsa tests a POS-light, low-data workflow for smaller Philippine food businesses.                                                                                                                  |
| What if there is no history?            | Start with owner baseline, confirmed orders, budget, and known constraints; show uncertainty until enough data exists.                                                                                                                 |
| What if you cause a stockout?           | The owner approves every plan; use ranges/buffers and explicitly track sellout timing and overrides.                                                                                                                                   |
| Why the budget feature?                 | For microbusinesses, the feasible decision may be constrained by tomorrow's cash, not just expected demand.                                                                                                                            |
| Who pays?                               | The owner/operator. Any price survives only if measured value repeatedly exceeds the fee and effort.                                                                                                                                   |
| Why Food Security?                      | It targets avoidable prepared-food loss and production efficiency; measure merchant-level outcomes rather than claim it solves hunger.                                                                                                 |

## Core pitch message

Tantsa helps small food-business owners turn limited cash, simple records, and uncertain demand into a practical daily preparation plan.

## 12. Risks, Boundaries, and Final Position

*What can invalidate the idea*

### Top risks

- The pain may not be frequent or expensive enough in the first segment.
- Manual data entry may be too burdensome; voice/photo capture may still be inaccurate.
- Poor recommendations may increase stockouts.
- Competitors may add similar planning features.
- Food-safety mistakes could create serious liability.
- Savings claims may be misleading if counterfactuals are double counted.
- The test subscription price may not convert despite comparable local software pricing.
- The name Tantsa requires proper trademark clearance before commercial use.
- Multi-branch purchasing and complex integrations can distract from validating the core decision.

### Measurement boundaries

- Do not count the full selling price of discarded food as money saved.
- Do not count the same unit as both prevented waste and recovered surplus.
- Weather, events, opening hours, and price changes can affect outcomes; simple before/after comparison does not prove causation.
- Keep actual observations separate from modeled estimates and illustrative scenarios.

### Final position

Proceed with Tantsa as a production-decision companion. Keep production planning at the heart of the product; keep leftover recovery as a secondary layer; use Kasya sa Puhunan, batch timing, voice/photo capture, and intraday updates only to strengthen the core decision.

### Brand

TANTSA - Guess Less. Make Right. Earn More.

## 13. Reference Notes and Evidence Status

*Source basis preserved from the previous SaktoServe guide*

**[E1]** INNOVATHON 2026 official event agenda supplied by the user.

**[S1]** Philippine Statistics Authority, 2024 ASPBI - Accommodation and Food Service Activities, final results (2026).

**[S2]** PSA Davao Region establishment statistics previously reviewed in concept research.

**[S3]** Philippine food-service research previously reviewed identifying overproduction/spoilage among waste causes.

**[S4]** Davao/local bakery operations research previously reviewed discussing demand forecasting and production scheduling.

**[C1]** Peddlr - public POS/inventory/offline features.

**[C2]** iCost - public food-costing/inventory/pricing features and a PHP 299 Plus price point previously reviewed.

**[C3]** KwentaPOS - public bakery POS/recipe/inventory features and a PHP 299 Pro price point previously reviewed.

**[C4]** ClearCOGS - restaurant preparation forecasting from POS data.

**[C5]** Guac - fresh-food demand forecasting and production planning.

**[C6]** Too Good To Go Platform - expiry/markdown/marketplace/donation features.

### Evidence status

Public sources and competitor offerings support the problem category and competitive context, but they do not establish local customer demand, merchant loss frequency, forecast lift, willingness to pay, retention, or unit economics. Those remain validation tasks.

All example quantities, savings, and pricing assumptions in this guide are illustrative unless attributed to a source. Public competitor features were not independently benchmarked through hands-on trials. This document merges the previous SaktoServe Complete Concept & Pitch Guide with the user-supplied revised concept, updates the brand to TANTSА, and retains the added budget, intraday, multimodal-input, cold-start, and measurement refinements.